

Prince Of Persia

Warrior Within

Blade of Darkness meets Sands of Time

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I personally thought 'Sands of Time' (SOT) was a very good game, blending just the right amount of 'platforming' with action. The chemistry between the two leads (the proud Prince and the lovely Farah) felt just right. Surprisingly, people weren't satisfied with the game (us gamers like to whine!). Since Ubisoft is one of the few companies that actually listen to their fans, they gladly obliged. 'Warrior Within' (WW) is basically a darker and an extremely violent (and frustrating) version of Sands of Time. One that practically bubbles with sexual references (don't even get me started on the outfits).

The story picks up from where SOT left off. After defeating the evil Vazir, the Prince rewinds time to make things right. He saves his father, his kingdom and Farah. Everyone's happy... except Fate: it was the Prince's destiny to die and by avoiding death, he really messed Fate's grand plans. Fate, a stickler for tidiness, sends a manifestation of itself, called the Dahaka, to clean things up. No man wants to die, so you play a Prince on-the-run, devoid of sleep or rest, which explains why he looks like someone killed his pet kitten.

Now With 100 Per Cent More Gore!

The game is tough, and no, it's not only because of the crappy controls (if you want

to really enjoy this game, play it with a joy pad). Right from the tutorial, enemies charge at you by the dozen. Thankfully, disposing them isn't a problem, due to the new 'Free Form Fighting' system. Dual wielding is now in the house, hacking is, thus, twice as fun.

Pick up any weapon dropped by your foe and use it to your advantage (you can even throw weapons at enemies and cut their heads off. How cool is that?) Every action during combat leads to various opportunities. Grapple an enemy and you can (a) cut his head off, (b) cut him in half vertically, (c) cut him in half horizontally, (d) strangle him, (e) throw him at other enemies, (f) thrust your sword in his back, remove it, take his

MASTER OF SWORDS

Awesome combat system
Stunning level design
Good soundtrack (if you like metal)
Fast loading times

MASTER OF PAIN

Repetitive at times
Too many monotonous boss fights
Bad camera angles